

Handout 3.3: Adolescence Myth vs Fact Sort

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____

Directions: This page has three parts and a stretch. Part 1 is the chart: four things that change in adolescence. Write one line for each in your own words. Part 2 is the sort: twelve statements. Each one is a myth (not true) or a fact (true). Write M or F. For every myth, write one sentence that corrects it. Use the chart to help. Part 3 is a case. Nothing on this page asks about you. Every “you” means people in general. Questions about puberty and reproductive health go to health class. There is a line for that on the exit card, and it is optional.

Word bank in Spanish

English	Spanish
brain	cerebro
sleep	sueño
feeling	sentimiento
myth	mito
fact	hecho
normal	normal

Part 1: Four things that change

Part (picture cue)	One change that is typical in adolescence, in your own words
Body (a ruler)	
Brain (a brain)	
Feelings (a face)	
Independence (a house key)	

Grade 6 word bank: growth spurt, sleep clock shifts later, prefrontal cortex still building, risks feel bigger, feelings swing fast, wants to decide, still needs family.

Part 2: Myth or fact

Write M or F next to each statement. Then write a one-sentence correction for each myth. There are six myths.

#	Statement	M or F	Correction (for myths): "This is a myth because ____"

1	Teenagers need less sleep than younger children.		
2	The part of the brain that plans ahead and hits the brakes keeps building into the mid 20s.		
3	Mood swings in adolescence usually mean something is wrong with the person.		
4	Growth spurts often make people clumsy for a while because arms and legs grow first.		
5	If a 13-year-old wants more privacy, it means they no longer need their family.		
6	Risks feel bigger and more exciting in adolescence than they will later, and friends nearby make that stronger.		
7	Everyone the same age should be at the same point in their growth.		
8	Teenagers get sleepy later at night because the body's clock shifts, not because they are lazy.		
9	Taking risks is always bad.		
10	Wanting to decide things for yourself		

	and still needing your family at the same time is normal.		
11	Because the brain is not finished, teenagers cannot be expected to control their actions.		
12	Feeling sad for a day or two after something bad happens is normal; feeling sad for weeks with no lift is a reason to tell an adult.		

Grade 6 and IEP/504: sort statements 1 to 8.

Part 3: The case

A 13-year-old wants to go to a friend's house on a school night. The parent says no. The door slams. Both of them feel bad an hour later.

What is the 13-year-old's brain doing? _____

What is the parent doing? _____

What would work better? Write one response that fits the brain at this age. Then write one reason.

Response bank (grade 6 and IEP/504, circle one): ask again when calm; offer a plan (homework first, home by 8); name the feeling out loud ("I am frustrated, not mad at you"); write it instead of saying it.

Response: _____

Reason: _____

"Normal" is a range (copy from the board)

The rule: _____

What is not "just a phase" and needs an adult:

(more) _____

The people at this school I can tell: _____

Grade 8 stretch (Part 4; you keep this, it is not turned in): write a four-sentence note to a parent or guardian. Explain what the prefrontal cortex (the planning and braking part of the brain) is doing at 13. Then name one thing that helps.

Line 1: _____

Line 2: _____

Line 3: _____

Exit card (3-2-1)

3 things that change in adolescence, one per part:

2 myths I can now correct: _____

1 question I have for the health teacher (optional; no name goes with it):
